Business

1. FedEx just reported its final quarterly earnings before spinning off its freight division — and the results surprised almost everyone. What happened?
   a. Earnings missed forecasts as the freight spin-off spooked investors
   b. Earnings beat expectations despite widespread predictions of logistics sector weakness
   c. Earnings were flat, with the freight business dragging down the core parcel unit

2. Memory chips — the components that store data inside your phone or laptop — are getting a lot more expensive right now. What is driving the shortage?
   a. A factory fire in South Korea wiped out a major share of global chip supply
   b. Soaring demand for AI systems is eating up chip supply that used to go to consumer electronics
   c. A new international export ban has blocked shipments from the largest producing countries

3. Lucid Group, the electric vehicle startup, just announced it is cutting roughly 18% of its US workforce and its chief operating officer has left the business with immediate effect. Why is Lucid restructuring so aggressively?
   a. To redirect resources into a new partnership with a major legacy automaker
   b. To cut costs and preserve cash as the company faces production challenges and funding pressure
   c. To comply with new US emissions regulations that require a leaner manufacturing footprint

4. A bumper harvest in Malaysia recently sent the price of durian — famously the world's smelliest fruit — crashing to just US$0.24 per kilogram. How fast did bargain hunters move when 3,000 kg went on sale?
   a. The entire stock sold out in five minutes
   b. It took most of the day, with buyers put off by the lingering aroma
   c. Sales were slow until a viral social media post sent shoppers rushing in

Economics

5. The Federal Reserve's preferred inflation gauge (a measure of how fast consumer prices are rising, which the Fed watches more closely than the headline CPI figure) hit a three-year high in May, with consumer prices up 4.1% compared to a year earlier. What was the main factor pushing it higher?
   a. A surge in housing costs driven by a shortage of rental properties
   b. A spike in gas prices, which peaked during the same month
   c. Rising food import costs following new agricultural tariffs

6. President Trump this week threatened to impose 100% tariffs (taxes on imports) on European countries that levy digital service taxes on US tech companies — just days after a trade deal with the EU was announced. Which of these is NOT a stated reason behind the threat?
   a. The US argues digital taxes unfairly target American companies like Google and Meta
   b. The administration wants to use tariff threats as leverage in broader trade negotiations
   c. The US claims European digital taxes violate World Trade Organization rules on services

7. Oil prices recently fell back to pre-war levels, with Brent crude (the international benchmark for oil pricing) dropping to $72.24 a barrel. What triggered the fall?
   a. OPEC agreed to raise production quotas at an emergency meeting in Vienna
   b. More oil tankers began exiting the Strait of Hormuz following a US-Iran deal
   c. A slowdown in Chinese industrial activity cut global demand forecasts sharply

8. Brexit changed where Britain's farms find their seasonal workers. Most people assumed EU citizens would simply be replaced by workers from other nearby European countries. What actually happened?
   a. British farms mostly automated, reducing their need for seasonal labour by around half
   b. The majority of seasonal farm workers in Britain now come from Central Asia — places like Kyrgyzstan and Tajikistan
   c. Most seasonal roles were filled by workers from India and the Philippines under new visa schemes

General Knowledge

9. Which country is the world's largest producer of cobalt, a metal that is essential for the lithium-ion batteries used in electric vehicles and smartphones?
   a. Chile
   b. Democratic Republic of Congo
   c. Australia

10. Which economist, writing in the 18th century, first argued that the wealth of a nation comes not from hoarding gold but from the productive labour of its people — an idea that helped dismantle mercantilism and shaped modern economics?
   a. David Ricardo
   b. John Maynard Keynes
   c. Adam Smith

Business

1. FedEx just reported its final quarterly earnings before spinning off its freight division — and the results surprised almost everyone. What happened?

b. FedEx beat expectations in its last quarter to include the freight business. Most analysts had anticipated weakness in the logistics sector, making the strong result a genuine surprise. The freight spin-off, once it completes, will mark one of the biggest structural changes in the company's history — separating a business that moves pallets from one that moves parcels.

2. Memory chips — the components that store data inside your phone or laptop — are getting a lot more expensive right now. What is driving the shortage?

b. The global AI race is the culprit. Data centres building out AI infrastructure are consuming enormous quantities of memory chips, leaving less supply for the consumer electronics market. Retailers of laptops and smartphones are now warning of price rises and possible product shortages — a reminder that the AI boom has costs that ripple far beyond Silicon Valley.

3. Lucid Group, the electric vehicle startup, just announced it is cutting roughly 18% of its US workforce and its chief operating officer has left the business with immediate effect. Why is Lucid restructuring so aggressively?

b. Lucid is restructuring to reduce costs and extend its cash runway. The EV startup has struggled with the expensive reality of scaling vehicle production, and with capital markets less enthusiastic about early-stage EV companies than they were a few years ago, preserving cash has become critical. The simultaneous departure of the COO signals this is a significant strategic reset, not a routine efficiency drive.

4. A bumper harvest in Malaysia recently sent the price of durian — famously the world's smelliest fruit — crashing to just US$0.24 per kilogram. How fast did bargain hunters move when 3,000 kg went on sale?

a. Three tonnes of durian vanished in five minutes flat. The glut is so severe that prices are expected to stay depressed until August, and free durian giveaways have been drawing massive crowds across the border in Singapore. It is a neat illustration of how agricultural supply shocks work: when harvest conditions are perfect, prices can collapse faster than farmers can plan for.

Economics

5. The Federal Reserve's preferred inflation gauge (a measure of how fast consumer prices are rising, which the Fed watches more closely than the headline CPI figure) hit a three-year high in May, with consumer prices up 4.1% compared to a year earlier. What was the main factor pushing it higher?

b. Gas prices peaked in May and were a key driver of the 4.1% annual rise. That figure matters politically as well as economically — elevated inflation gives the Federal Reserve less room to cut interest rates (the price of borrowing money), and it creates headaches for the White House ahead of the midterm elections. Energy prices are volatile, but when they move, they move the whole index.

6. President Trump this week threatened to impose 100% tariffs (taxes on imports) on European countries that levy digital service taxes on US tech companies — just days after a trade deal with the EU was announced. Which of these is NOT a stated reason behind the threat?

c. The WTO argument has not been a stated basis for Trump's threat. The administration's case rests on the idea that European digital taxes are discriminatory because they fall disproportionately on US tech giants, and that the threat of 100% tariffs gives Washington bargaining power. A 100% tariff would effectively double the price of affected European goods entering the US — a significant escalation even by recent standards.

7. Oil prices recently fell back to pre-war levels, with Brent crude (the international benchmark for oil pricing) dropping to $72.24 a barrel. What triggered the fall?

b. A US-Iran deal allowed tankers to move more freely through the Strait of Hormuz, the narrow waterway through which roughly a fifth of the world's traded oil passes. When that chokepoint is disrupted, energy markets get nervous fast. The fall to $72.24 a barrel eased fears of an extended supply shock — though prices at this level still reflect a world of considerable geopolitical uncertainty.

8. Brexit changed where Britain's farms find their seasonal workers. Most people assumed EU citizens would simply be replaced by workers from other nearby European countries. What actually happened?

b. A decade on from Brexit, Central Asian workers from countries including Kyrgyzstan and Tajikistan make up the majority of Britain's seasonal agricultural workforce. Agricultural industry chiefs say that without them, many farms would simply fail. It is one of the more unexpected consequences of leaving the EU — the labour gap was filled not from nearby, but from thousands of miles away.

General Knowledge

9. Which country is the world's largest producer of cobalt, a metal that is essential for the lithium-ion batteries used in electric vehicles and smartphones?

b. The Democratic Republic of Congo produces around 70% of the world's cobalt supply, making it one of the most strategically important countries in the global clean energy transition. That concentration of supply in a single politically unstable country is a significant concern for carmakers and battery manufacturers trying to secure long-term supply chains.

10. Which economist, writing in the 18th century, first argued that the wealth of a nation comes not from hoarding gold but from the productive labour of its people — an idea that helped dismantle mercantilism and shaped modern economics?

c. Adam Smith made this argument in The Wealth of Nations, published in 1776. His attack on mercantilism — the then-dominant idea that national wealth meant accumulating gold and silver — was revolutionary. Smith argued that trade, specialisation, and labour productivity were the true engines of prosperity, a foundation that most economic thinking still builds on today.